

Project Close-out Report

Prisma DIDs: Decentralized IDs for Verifiable Contributions

Prepared for the Cardano community and Project Catalyst

Submission note: The project URL and public close-out video link remain to be added before final submission.

Name of project and Project URL on IdeaScale/Fund

Prisma DIDs: Decentralized IDs for Verifiable Contributions

[Add Project Catalyst / IdeaScale proposal URL before submission]

Your Project Number

#1400101

Name of project manager

Noah Biel

Date project started

December 2025

Date project completed

Original completion target: April 2026.

Final delivery: August 2026.

Project close-out summary

Prisma DIDs began with a simple question: how can people in the Cardano ecosystem create a decentralized identity and prove meaningful contributions without giving up control of their data? Our answer was two connected, open-source applications. Prisma DIDs gives people a wallet-linked decentralized identifier (DID) that they can create and manage. Prisma VCs makes it possible to issue, receive, share, and verify contribution records connected to those identities.

An organisation can issue a contribution stating that someone completed a defined number of work hours, with supporting evidence. The holder can review the request in their wallet, approve it by signing, or reject it if the information is wrong. The credential can then be shared with only the information the holder chooses to disclose, while allowing others to independently verify it.

The technical delivery was led by Mateo Dazza and Carlos Quintana. Their prior experience in Web3 projects and hackathons supported a practical, delivery-focused approach, including the refinement of the architecture and delivery of the open-source prototype.

List of challenge KPIs and how the project addressed them

The original proposal targeted 250+ DIDs, 500+ verifiable credentials, 500+ validation transactions, 3+ pilot organisations, 70%+ monthly retention, 50+ cross-network identity-portability instances, and 80%+ of users defining their own data preferences.

We delivered the foundation needed to address these targets: DID registration, verifiable credential issuance and verification, privacy controls, a public testnet MVP, documentation, security review, testing, and an open-source codebase. Co-design documentation with three pilot organisations was completed.

The documented onboarding record shows 20 DIDs created by collaborators. This exceeded the Milestone 2 target of 15. It did not reach the original 250+ project-level target. Final aggregate figures for VCs, validation transactions, retention, portability, and users configuring data preferences were not available for this draft. We state this openly. The delivered selective-disclosure interface directly addresses the goal of user-controlled data preferences.

List of project KPIs and how the project addressed them

Milestone 1: Co-design and technical specification. We completed co-design documentation with three pilot organisations, a technical specification, UX mock-ups, a Cardano integration plan, and a requirements summary.

Milestone 2: Development. We delivered wallet-connected DID registration and documented 20 collaborator DIDs. We also delivered VC issuance and verification modules, selective-disclosure privacy controls, a DID-management interface, API documentation, and public testnet deployments.

Milestone 3: Testing and refinement. We delivered an external infrastructure and platform-architecture security audit by ReFaz, a pilot implementation report, feedback analysis, a comprehensive test plan and test cases, updated documentation, and publicly accessible MVPs.

Milestone 4: Close-out and community. The user guide/manual has been prepared in PDF, Word, and Markdown formats. Community onboarding materials, active feedback channels, the community-feedback summary, and the public close-out video remain to be finalised and linked.

Key achievements (in particular around collaboration and engagement)

Prisma DIDs and Prisma VCs now work together as a public, open-source prototype. A person can connect a Cardano wallet, create or view a DID, and use that identity in a verifiable-contribution flow. An issuer can create a contribution record; the holder can review it through their wallet; and the contribution can be selectively disclosed, shared, and independently verified.

We turned early collaboration into concrete project outputs. The co-design process involved three pilot organisations, and the onboarding process documented 20 collaborator DIDs. Feedback, testing, and implementation reporting were captured as project materials to guide refinement.

A further achievement is the project's testnet-first operating model. Prisma DIDs was initially explored through a Cardano-mainnet smart-contract approach, but we identified that DID issuance through this model could create an unnecessary ADA cost for users. Instead of making identity creation dependent on tokens with real monetary value, we delivered a functional Cardano testnet solution using testnet tokens.

This creates meaningful potential for Cardano. It shows that testnet-based applications can be designed for real user interaction, not only developer testing. Communities, organisations, and contributors can create DIDs, issue and review verifiable contributions, experiment with privacy settings, and verify credentials in an accessible environment. Prisma DIDs offers a practical model for future user-centred Cardano solutions where onboarding, learning, collaboration, and experimentation should not be blocked by transaction costs.

Key learnings

Our biggest learning came early. The initial direction considered Plutus or Aiken smart contracts on Cardano mainnet and a multichain future. We concluded that creating a DID through that model would make users pay too much ADA. That was not aligned with the accessible, user-first product we wanted to build.

We therefore made Prisma DIDs operational in the Cardano testnet environment with testnet tokens. The delivered solution uses Cardano-native components, including CIP-10, CIP-20, and CIP-30, alongside IPFS metadata storage and an indexer. The specification also aligns with W3C DID Core 1.0, W3C VC Data Model 2.0, IETF SD-JWT selective disclosure, and RFC 8785 JSON canonicalization.

Treasury volatility also shaped delivery. From grant award to receipt of the first Milestone 1 payment, ADA fell from approximately USD 0.80 to approximately USD 0.38. This reduced the grant's fiat-equivalent purchasing power and contributed to delivery extending beyond the original April 2026 target. We responded by prioritising the essential product, maintaining open-source delivery, and working in stages.

Next steps for the product or service developed

The immediate priority is to complete the remaining community and close-out deliverables: publish the user guide in the project documentation area, establish and moderate feedback channels, publish a community-feedback and ideas summary, and release the public close-out video.

The next product iteration can be guided by public prototype use, implementation feedback, test results, and community input. The open-source repository and API documentation give future contributors and organisations a base for contribution tracking, attestations, and user-controlled credential sharing.

Any future mainnet or cross-network work should preserve the core lesson from this project: decentralized identity must be practical, understandable, privacy-preserving, and economically accessible.

Final thoughts/comments

We are proud that Prisma DIDs evolved from an idea into a working, publicly accessible prototype despite significant technical and financial constraints. The project did not meet every original scale target during the funded period, and we state that openly. It did deliver a real, inspectable foundation: decentralized identity creation and management, consent-based verifiable contributions, selective disclosure, public testnet applications, testing and feedback materials, open-source documentation, and external security-review evidence.

The shift away from the original smart-contract/mainnet direction was not a step back from the project's purpose. It was a

practical decision to put users first and avoid making DID creation unnecessarily expensive.

Prisma DIDs is more than a DID prototype. It is an example of how Cardano testnet infrastructure can support meaningful, user-facing applications. By making decentralized identity and verifiable contributions operable with testnet tokens, the project reduces the economic barrier to participation while retaining Cardano-native wallet connectivity, metadata, transaction references, privacy controls, and verification flows.

We believe this has value beyond the project itself. The testnet-first model can help open the door for other Cardano teams to create accessible solutions for communities, contribution tracking, education, onboarding, experimentation, and early product validation.

Links to other relevant project sources or documents

Repository: <https://github.com/prisma-collective/Dids>

Prisma DIDs MVP: <https://dids-dashboard-production.up.railway.app/>

Prisma VCs MVP: <https://vcs-dashboard-production.up.railway.app/>

API documentation: <https://github.com/prisma-collective/Dids/blob/main/documentation/API.md>

Documentation: <https://github.com/prisma-collective/dids/tree/main/documentation>

Security audit: https://github.com/prisma-collective/dids/blob/main/documentation/PRISMA_DIDS_Security_Audit_Report.pdf

Implementation report: https://github.com/prisma-collective/dids/blob/main/documentation/IMPLEMENTATION_REPORT.md

Feedback analysis: https://github.com/prisma-collective/dids/blob/main/documentation/FEEDBACK_ANALYSIS_FROM_IMPLEMENTATION_REPORT.md

Test plan: https://github.com/prisma-collective/dids/blob/main/documentation/TEST_PLAN.md

Selective-disclosure demo: <https://youtu.be/uDSpbrn828o>

DID-management demo: <https://youtu.be/w86RPFpbwPM>

DID onboarding record: <https://airtable.com/appivPJCmhlz4OZHO/shrCojshEPal1z4Q9>

Link to Close-out video (YouTube or Vimeo only)

[To be added: public YouTube or Vimeo link]